

LOW CODE

EXPERIMENT - 2

Setting Up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

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AIM

To set up a Zoho Creator account, create and explore a sample application using forms, reports, and dashboards, and understand the basic platform architecture and the Develop, Deploy, and Manage sections of the Zoho Creator interface.

SETTING UP ZOHO CREATOR

Zoho Creator is a cloud-based low-code application development platform. Applications can be created through a browser using visual development tools, without requiring large amounts of manual programming.

1) Create the Sample Application

1. Open the Zoho Creator website and sign in using an existing Zoho account. If an account is not available, create a new Zoho account and proceed to Zoho Creator.
2. From the Zoho Creator home page, select the option to create a new application or solution.
3. Select Applications and choose Create from Scratch to build a new application manually.
4. Provide an appropriate name for the application, such as “Corporate Asset Maintenance”, and create the application.
5. Once the application is created, the Application Design window will be displayed. This interface allows users to add and configure components such as Forms, Reports, Pages, and Workflows.
6. For this experiment, create a simple Student Management System consisting of a Student Details Form, Student Report, and Student Dashboard.

Creating a Form

A form is used to collect and store data from users. In Zoho Creator, forms are one of the main components of an application. Create the Student Details form and add fields such as Student Name, Register Number, Department, Email and Phone Number.

7. Open the created application in Edit/Design mode to modify its components.
8. Click the + (Add) option and select Form from the available components.
9. Choose From Scratch and provide the form name as “Student Details”.
10. Add the required fields to the form by dragging and dropping them into the form builder.
11. Configure the properties and settings of each field according to the requirements, then save the form.
12. Open the Student Details form in Live mode and enter a few sample student records for testing.

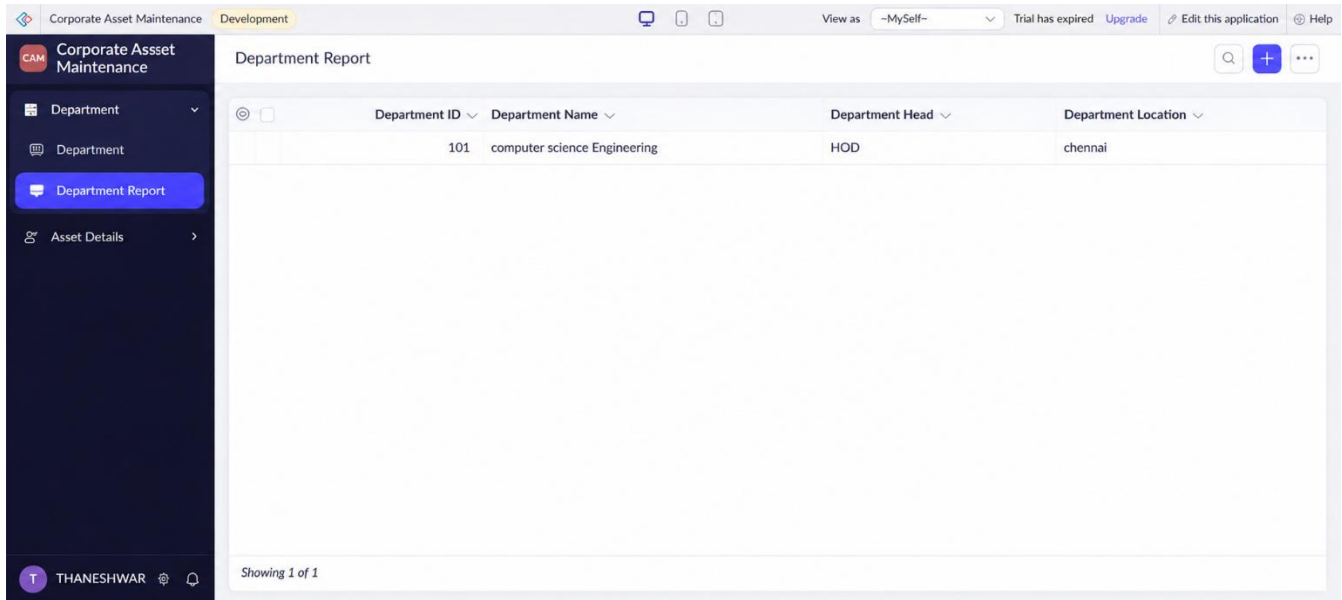
The screenshot displays the Zoho Creator form builder interface. At the top, the application name 'Corporate Asset Maintenance Department' is visible. The 'Basic Fields' panel on the left offers various field types: Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, and Drop Down. The main workspace shows a form with four fields: 'Department ID' (highlighted), 'Department Name', 'Department Head', and 'Department Location'. The 'Field Properties' panel on the right is configured for the 'Department ID' field, showing its name, link name, display format, validation options, initial value, and maximum digits.

Creating a Report

A report presents the data collected through a form in an organized and meaningful manner. A List Report is generally created automatically when a form is created. Additional reports can also be created and customized based on the application's requirements.

1. Open the Application Design page.
2. Select the option to Add a New Report if an additional report is required.

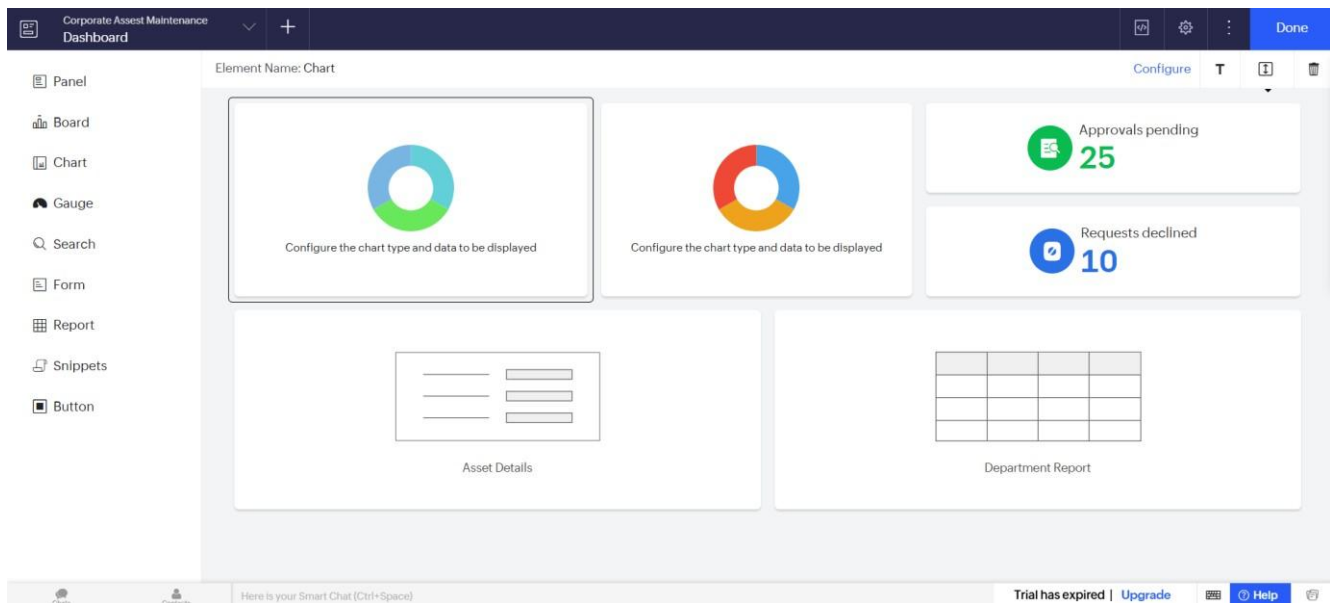
3. Select the Student Details form as the data source for the report.
4. Choose an appropriate report format, such as List Report.
5. Provide the report name as “Student Report”.
6. Configure the required sorting, filtering, or grouping options and save the report.



Creating a Dashboard

A **dashboard** provides a visual representation of application data and allows important information, metrics, and reports to be viewed in a single location. For this experiment, a **Student Dashboard** is created using the data collected through the Student Details form.

19. Open the **Application/Page Builder** and create or access the required dashboard or page section.
20. Provide the dashboard name as “**Student Dashboard**”.
21. Add appropriate **reports, charts, or other visual components** based on the data available in the **Student Details** form.
22. Arrange and customize the added components using the **drag-and-drop interface** to achieve a clear and organized layout.
23. Save the dashboard and **preview it** to verify that all student information and visual components are displayed correctly.



Creating and Configuring the Student Dashboard

A dashboard provides a centralized and visual representation of the information stored in an application. It helps users quickly understand important data by displaying reports, charts, summaries, and other visual components in a single interface. Dashboards can be customized according to the application's requirements to make the information easier to analyze and interpret.

For this experiment, a Student Dashboard is created using the data collected through the Student Details form and displayed through the Student Report.

19. Open the Application Builder/Page Builder from the Zoho Creator application and navigate to the section where dashboards or pages can be created and customized.
20. Select the option to create a new dashboard or page and provide the name "Student Dashboard".
21. Configure the basic properties of the dashboard and select an appropriate layout that allows the required information to be displayed clearly.
22. Add the Student Report to the dashboard so that the student records stored in the application can be viewed directly from the dashboard.
23. Add suitable visual components, such as charts, graphs, summary panels, or other relevant widgets, based on the information available in the Student Details form.
24. Configure the properties of each component, including the required data source, fields, labels, filters, and display settings.
25. Arrange the added reports and visual components using the drag-and-drop interface to create a well-organized and user-friendly dashboard layout.

26. Resize and reposition the components wherever necessary to ensure that the information is presented clearly without unnecessary overlapping or empty spaces.
27. Apply suitable filters, sorting options, or grouping criteria to the components when required so that users can easily analyze specific student information.
28. Save the completed Student Dashboard after configuring all the required components and settings.
29. Use the Preview/Live mode to view the dashboard and verify that the reports, charts, and other components are functioning correctly.
30. Check whether the student information is displayed accurately and ensure that the dashboard reflects the latest data entered through the Student Details form.
31. Make any necessary modifications to the layout, components, or display settings and save the final version of the dashboard.
32. The completed Student Dashboard provides a consolidated view of student information and demonstrates how Zoho Creator can be used to present application data in an organized and visually meaningful manner.

RESULT

The Zoho Creator account and sample Student Management System application were successfully set up and explored. A form was created to collect student data, a report was used to display the collected data, and a dashboard was created to provide a visual summary. The Develop, Deploy and Manage sections of the Zoho Creator platform were also studied.